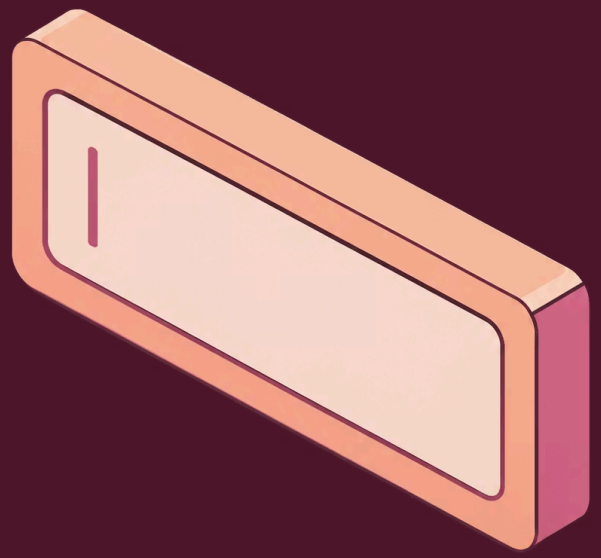


HTML Form Elements Cheat Sheet

A complete reference for developers learning HTML forms — organized by input type for fast, practical lookup.

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Text Input Fields

<input type="text">

Single-line text entry

<input type="email">

Email with built-in validation

<input type="password">

Masked text input

<input type="tel">

Phone numbers

<input type="url">

Web addresses with validation

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Numeric & Date Inputs

type="number"

Integers and decimals with spinner controls

type="date"

Native browser date picker

type="time"

Hour/minute time picker

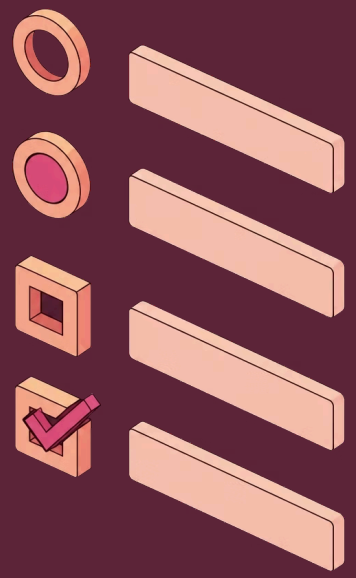
type="range"

Slider control for a value range

type="color"

Native color picker swatch

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Selection Controls

<input type="radio">

Single choice from a group — only one can be selected at a time.

<input type="checkbox">

Multiple independent selections.

<select> + <option>

Dropdown menu. Add `multiple` attribute for multi-select.

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Text Areas & File Upload



`<textarea>`

Multi-line text input. Set size with `rows` and `cols` attributes.



`<input type="file">`

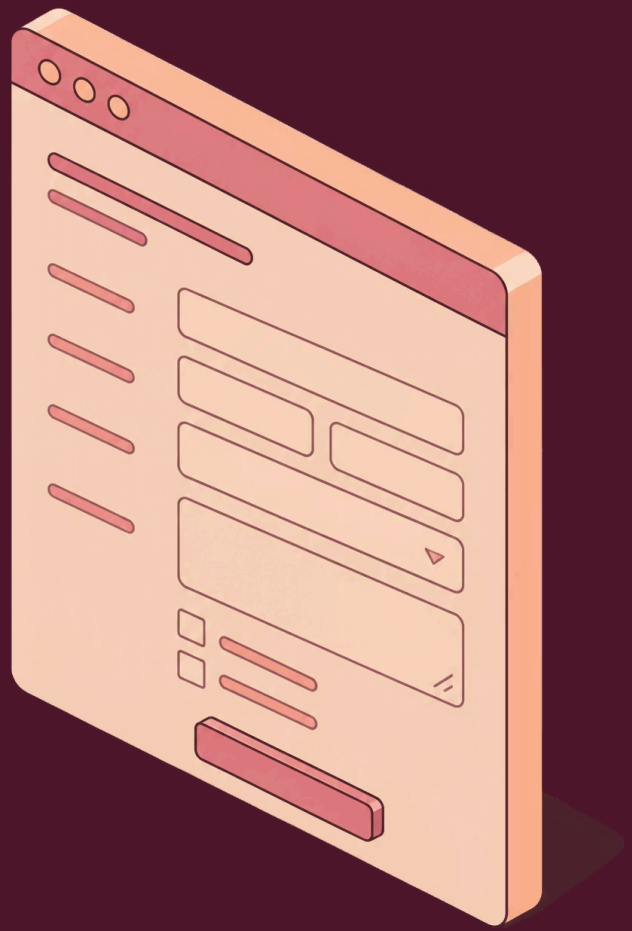
Opens a file browser. Use `accept` to restrict file types.



`<input type="hidden">`

Passes data invisibly — not rendered in the UI but submitted with the form.

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Form Structure & Accessibility

1

<form action="" method="">

Outer wrapper. Sets where and how data is sent.

2

<fieldset> + **<legend>**

Groups related inputs with a visible title for screen readers.

3

<label for="">

Links labels to inputs. **Required** for accessibility — never skip.

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Buttons & Submission

type="submit"	type="reset"	type="button"
Sends all form data to the server.	Clears all fields to their default values.	No default behavior — wired via JavaScript.

Always use `<button>` over `<input type="submit">` — it supports inner HTML and is more flexible.



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Common Attributes

Attribute	Purpose	Example
`placeholder`	Hint text inside the field	`placeholder="Enter email"`
`required`	Field must be filled before submit	`required`
`minlength / maxlength`	Text character limits	`minlength="8" maxlength="50"`
`min / max`	Number or date range limits	`min="0" max="100"`
`pattern`	Regex validation rule	`pattern="[A-Za-z]{3}"`
`accept`	Restrict file types on upload	`accept=".pdf,.png"`

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Smart Input Features

`<datalist>`

Provides autocomplete suggestions. Pair with `<input list="id">`.

Mobile Keyboards

Mobile browsers show adapted keyboards based on input type — numeric pad for `tel`, email layout for `email`.

Built-in Validation

Browsers auto-validate `email`, `url`, and `number` types — no JavaScript needed.



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Quick Example

A minimal but complete form with proper structure, accessibility, and validation:

```
<form action="/submit" method="POST">

  <fieldset>
    <legend>Contact Us</legend>

    <label for="name">Name</label>
    <input type="text" id="name"
           name="name" required
           placeholder="Jane Smith">

    <label for="email">Email</label>
    <input type="email" id="email"
           name="email" required
           placeholder="you@example.com">

    <label for="message">Message</label>
    <textarea id="message" name="message"
              rows="4" minlength="10">
    </textarea>

    <button type="submit">Send</button>
    <button type="reset">Clear</button>

  </fieldset>
</form>
```

✅ <fieldset> + <legend>

Groups fields for accessibility and clarity.

✅ <label for="">

Every input has a linked label — screen-reader ready.

✅ required + minlength

Browser validation with zero JavaScript.

✅ Two button types

`submit` sends data; `reset` clears fields.

Pro tip: Combine `required`, `pattern`, and `type` for robust validation before the form ever reaches your server.

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